

St. Andrews Institute Of Technology And Management

BCA -3rd semester

Communication Skills

UNIT-1

INTRODUCTION TO BASICS OF COMMUNICATION

Meaning of communication:- communication is the flow of information and understanding from one person to another at the same level or at different levels. It is a process which enables management to allocate and supervise the work of the employees.

The word communication is derived from the latin word 'communicare' that means to share, to make common, to impart, to participate, convey or transmit. As such communication may be defined as the sharing or exchange of messages, facts, opinions, ideas or attitudes and emotions between a sender (manager) and receiver (employees) or between two or more people. In other words communication is the process through which two or more persons come to exchange ideas and understanding among themselves.

DEFINITIONS

According to peter little "communication is the process by which information is transmitted between individuals and/ or organizations so that an understanding response results."

According to keith davis "communication is the process of passing the information and understanding from one person to another. It is essentially a bridge between the people. By using the bridge, a person can safely cross the river of understanding."

According to John Adair "Communication is essentially the ability of one person to make contact with another and make himself or herself understood."

According to Louis A. allen, "communication is the sum total of all the things that a person does,when he wants to create an understanding in the mind of another. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding".

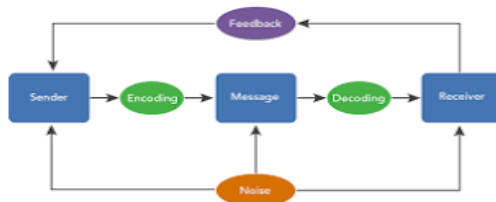
FEATURES/ CHARACTERISTICS OF COMUNICATION

1. **Universal-** communication is universal phenomenon. All living creatures(human beings, birds, beasts, etc) communicate through their own symbols and signs.
2. **Communication is unavoidable** – communication is always an existing and unavoidable phenomenon. Not only facial expressions, positive gestures and other behavioral ways, even silence also conveys a lot about the persons attitude.

3. **Continuous process**- it is not an act or event of time rather; it is a continuous process incorporating various events and activities that interrelated are interdependent.
4. **Two-way traffic**- it is not complete unless, the receiver understands the message. To ensure that the receiver has understood the message, there should be some sort of feedback. Thus, the communication is two-way and not the one-way traffic.
5. **Short-lived process**- the process of communication is incomplete as soon as the message is received and understood by the receiver in the right perspective; hence it is short lived process.
6. **Needs proper understanding**- There may be numerous media of communication but the main purpose of conveying the message is a proper understanding of the message by the other party. For this purpose, it should be clearly and concisely worded.
7. **Leads achievement of the organizational objective**- effective communication does this by creating the sense of object orientation in the organization.
8. **Dispels misunderstanding**- in this sense, it provides clear understanding between persons and thus, builds a bridge of companionship among people.

PROCESS OF COMMUNICATION

The process of communication refers to the transmission or passage of information or message from the sender through a selected channel to the receiver overcoming barriers that affect its pace. The different elements in the process of communication – Sender-Message-Encoding.



- **Sender.** The person delivering the message
- **Receiver.** The person getting the message
- **Message:** The information the sender is relaying to the receiver
- **Communication channel:** The method used to transmit a message
- **Decoding:** Interpreting the message, done by the receiver
- **Feedback:** When applicable, a response sent back to the sender

All communication tends to follow this framework, which provides detail on every step of the process.

- **Developing the Message** -The sender starts the steps of communication by creating a message they intend to send to an individual or group. They take time to craft the information they want to transmit.

- **Encoding the Message** -With the information created, the sender translates it into a form that can be transmitted to someone else. This involves making the information fit a format, such as text or video.
- **Selecting the Channel**-The sender picks the channel communication. It should be a channel that is most appropriate for the intended audience. Examples include a social media post, video on YouTube or blog entry on a website.
- **Message Transmission**-The sender then successfully transmits the message to the receiver.
- **Decoding the Message** -The receiver decodes the information received. For the best messaging, the sender has attempted to place themselves in the shoes of the receiver and crafted a message that the receiver will understand as the sender intended. This is the key to effective communication, but senders do not know if they have achieved success until this step.
- **Feedback** -Senders learn the effectiveness of their message when receiving feedback. However, in one-way communication, there's no chance for the receiver to provide feedback. That's situation public relations and advertisers want to avoid.

BARRIERS OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Communication is defined as the process by which information is exchanged between individuals through a system of signs, symbols. The concept of communication involves a sender, a message and a recipient.

The sender sends the message and the recipient is the receiver of the message. The process of communication is never smooth as it is affected by the barriers of communication.

Barriers to effective communication can result in confusion which can lead to incorrect information being conveyed or miscommunication which can lead to loss of business.

Following are some of the barriers to effective communication:

1. Semantic barriers
2. Psychological barriers
3. Organizational barriers
4. Cultural barriers
5. Physical barriers
6. Physiological barriers

Let us study in detail about the various types of barriers to effective communication.

SEMANTICS BARRIERS- Semantic barriers are also known as language barriers. These barriers are caused due to improper communication between the sender and the receiver. The following instances of semantic barriers can be witnessed in communication.

Poor quality of message: Message when communicated should be precise and easy to understand, that makes it easy for the receiver to grasp the information conveyed.

Sometimes, due to the lack of clarity or complexity of the way of providing information from the sender, there can be a case of semantic barriers.

For e.g. A manager is conversing in English to a group of workers who understand and speak Bengali. It will create confusion among workers as they will not be able to understand what is being conveyed by the manager.

Technical language: Language barriers also arise when the sender of the message is speaking in technical terms while the receiver is unaware of the terms. It creates confusion and misunderstanding between the sender and receiver by acting as a barrier to effective communication.

PSYCHOLOGICAL BARRIERS: Psychological barriers play an important role in interpersonal communication as the state of the mind of the sender or the receiver can make it difficult to understand the information that is conveyed, which often leads to misunderstanding.

Here are some instances where psychological barriers to communication can be seen.

1. Premature evaluation of information by the receiver even before it is transmitted can lead to barriers in communication, as it will create premature conclusion to the message, which withholds the original message.
2. Inadequate attention from the receiver's end at the time of communication can lead to barriers of communication as the information conveyed by the sender is not properly received by the receiver.
3. When information is passed within multiple sources, the final information is distorted as the receivers of the message are not able to retain everything that was conveyed. This can cause communication barriers.

ORGANIZATIONAL BARRIERS: Organizational barriers are those barriers that are caused due to the structure, rules and regulations present in the organization. The various types of barriers that can be encountered due to superior subordinate relationships where the free flow of communication is not possible.

Sometimes the complexity of organizational structure and multiple managers make it difficult to convey information properly, and the information gets distorted leading to miscommunication.

CULTURAL BARRIERS: Cultural barriers are those that arise due to lack of similarities among the different cultures across the world. A term that can be harmless in one culture can be regarded as slang in another culture. Moreover, various beliefs can differ from one culture to another.

PHYSICAL BARRIERS: Physical barriers to communication are those that arise due to certain factors like faulty equipment, noise, closed doors and cabins that cause the information sent from sender to receiver to become distorted, which results in improper communication.

PHYSIOLOGICAL BARRIERS: Physiological barriers arise when a sender or the receiver of the communication is not in a position to express or receive the message with clarity due to some physiological issues like dyslexia, or nerve disorders that interfere with speech or hearing.